



Township of Hillsborough

COUNTY OF SOMERSET
THE PETER J. BIONDI BUILDING
379 SOUTH BRANCH ROAD
HILLSBOROUGH, NJ 08844
(908) 369-4313
www.hillsborough-nj.org

PLEASE AVOID THESE COMMON RECYCLING MISTAKES!

Just placing items you THINK are recyclable into the curbside pickup does not mean they will be recycled. If too many of the wrong items are included in curbside recycling, such as plastic bags, wet cardboard, etc (known as “contamination”), much of the material will be disposed of in a landfill as garbage.

Plastic Bags or Plastic Wrap

Plastic bags and wraps get tangled around moving equipment in recycling facilities and cause costly downtime. Plastic bags and wrap should not be placed into curbside recycling in Somerset County. Also, recyclables, such as plastic bottles, should NOT be put in the curbside bin in plastic bags!! Please dispose of in the garbage or at retail collection bins.



Wet Cardboard / Paper

Cardboard is baled for transportation, in the same way that farmers use hay bales. Wet cardboard cannot be baled, and will very likely be disposed of into a landfill. Wet cardboard should not be placed into curbside recycling in Somerset County. Keep cardboard clean, dry, and if not possible due to the weather, consider holding it for another recycling day or bring it to a recycling drop off location.



Lithium / Rechargeable Batteries

Lithium & rechargeable batteries should not be placed into curbside recycling in Somerset County curbside pickup as they routinely start fires both in collection trucks and at recycling facilities. They are required to be disposed of at a Hazardous Waste Day



NOT ALL PLASTIC IS RECYCLED IN SOMERSET COUNTY!!

Items such as plastic toys, flower pots, soft drink cups, etc should not be placed into curbside recycling in Somerset County and should be disposed of in the trash.



ADDITIONAL PROPER RECYCLING TIPS

- Please be aware: Just because an item or material says it is recyclable does not mean it is recycled in Somerset County, NJ. Many manufacturers place their own determination whether their product, or the packaging it comes in, are recyclable. While it may in fact be possible to recycle these items, the facility that processes recyclables in Somerset County NJ may not have the equipment to do so. If included into curbside recycling, these items become "contamination".
- The most important phrase to remember is **"When in doubt, throw it out"**. Even though it may seem counterproductive, it is a better idea to throw an item you are not 100% sure is recyclable in SOMERSET COUNTY into the garbage than into recycling. If there is too much contamination in recycling, all materials will be disposed of in a landfill as it is too expensive/difficult to sort the good material from the bad.
- For more information on how to properly recycle, please refer to the Somerset County Recycling page:
<https://www.co.somerset.nj.us/government/public-works/recycling>

THANK YOU FOR RECYCLING PROPERLY !!!